

Mitigating Anchoring Bias in Long-Term Auditor Engagements

An EFA-Based Validation Study

Yasir A. Malik · PID 1687105 · FIU DBA Cohort 7.16

GEB7913 · Advisor **Prof. Dr. Juan Rey** · IRB IRB-25-0462

The study. Which audit-process interventions most effectively reduce **anchoring bias** in long-term (multi-year) auditor engagements? Eleven constructs and a sixteen-hypothesis model (proposed framework). **For this summer project, the analysis validates the measurement model via exploratory factor analysis and reliability** on a target of **n = 100 valid** audit-professional responses; hypothesis and mediation testing are future research (per advisor directive, 2026-06-30).

Figure 1 — Eight interventions → two mediators → reduction in anchoring bias.

■ Start here

Open this	What it is
■ PROGRESS_TRACKER.md	Live status + dated path to the manuscript — read this first
■ Full_Survey_Questionnaire_v2.docx	The instrument (v2.1, post peer review)
■ Research_Paper_YMalik_v4.docx	Full paper — Ch. 1–3, model, hypotheses
■■ DBA_Master_Action_Pack.pdf	Week-by-week action plan

■ **Live survey:** https://fiu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_3lae5xJsPcRfIN0

■ Status snapshot

Piece	State
Survey built + published in Qualtrics (73 items)	■ LIVE
Verified end-to-end on mobile	■
CloudResearch recruiting project (15 × \$6, US, \$90)	■ Draft built
Peer review #1 — wording (CPA/CFA/FRM)	■ Incorporated → v2.1
Peer review #2 — methodology	■ Addressed (Limitations section)
Dr. Rey methodology meeting	■ Thu Jul 2, 11 AM
Data collection → EFA → manuscript	■ Jul 1–19

■■ Timeline

When	Milestone	Status
Jul 1	Survey LIVE + CloudResearch draft	■

When	Milestone	Status
Jul 2, 11 AM	Dr. Rey methodology meeting	■
Jul 2–3	Finalize → fund → soft-launch (data begins)	■
Jul 3–8	Scale to n = 100 valid	■
Jul 9–10	Clean data	■
Jul 11–13	EFA + reliabilities	■
Jul 14–17	Write Results + Discussion	■
Jul 18–19	Submit final manuscript	■

■ The instrument

11 constructs × 5 items = **55 construct items**, + 2 attention checks, 5 screeners, a context control, an open item, and demographics → **74 respondent-facing items**. 5-point Likert (decision documented vs 7-point).

File	Purpose
Full_Survey_Questionnaire_v2.md	Reviewed instrument (v2.1) + change log
Qualtrics_Survey_Import.txt	One-click Qualtrics import (Advanced Format)
Qualtrics_Codebook_and_Setup.md	Reverse-code map + 7-step post-import setup

■ Peer review → 04_Peer_Review/

File	Purpose
Note_and_Responses_to_Richard_2026-06-21.docx	Reviewer-facing "you flagged → we did → why"
Peer_Review_Response_Richard_2026-06-21.docx	Formal point-by-point response
Methodological_Limitations_and_Remedies.md	Pre-empts review #2 (CMB, discriminant validity, self-report) — Podsakoff 2003 + Fornell-Larcker 1981

■ Recruitment & launch → 03_Recruitment_and_Pilot/

File	Purpose
LIVE_Survey_Status.md	Live link + before-launch checklist
CloudResearch_Setup_Guide.docx	8-step launch (primary recruiting route)
Informed_Pilot_Run_Plan.docx	Pilot (6–10 auditors) + 6 decision gates

■ Advisor & meeting → correspondence/

File	Purpose
2026-06-30_Rey_meeting_July2_request.md	July 2 meeting email + agenda

File	Purpose
Milestones_and_Timeline.md	12 milestones with gates

■ Methods at a glance

- **Sample: n = 100 valid** US audit professionals via CloudResearch (MTurk backup).
- **Analysis (this project):** EFA — **Principal Axis Factoring + Direct Oblimin rotation**, KMO + Bartlett + parallel analysis; reliability (Cronbach's α). *No mediation/hypothesis testing this term (advisor directive); model + hypotheses are the proposed framework / future research.*
- **Item rule:** remove loadings < .30; decide .30–.40 case-by-case (keep if removal worsens the pattern matrix).
- **Theory lens:** dual-process theory via the anchoring-and-adjustment heuristic.
- **Rigor remedies:** anonymity, reverse items, block randomization, attention checks; planned Harman's test + marker variable for common method bias.

■■ Repository map

dba/
 ■■■ README.md ← you are here
 ■■■ PROGRESS_TRACKER.md ← live status (start here)
 ■■■ LIVE_Survey_Status.md ← live link + launch checklist
 ■■■ Research_Paper_YMalik_v4.docx ← full paper
 ■■■ Anchoring_Bias_Research_Model.png ← Figure 1
 ■■■ Full_Survey_Questionnaire_v2.* ← instrument v2.1
 ■■■ Qualtrics_Survey_Import.txt ← one-click build
 ■■■ Qualtrics_Codebook_and_Setup.md
 ■■■ Methodological_Limitations_and_Remedies.* ← pre-empts review #2
 ■■■ CloudResearch_Setup_Guide.*
 ■■■ Informed_Pilot_Run_Plan.*
 ■■■ Milestones_and_Timeline.*
 ■■■ DBA_Master_Action_Pack.pdf
 ■■■ 03_Recruitment_and_Pilot/ ← pilot + recruiting packet
 ■■■ 04_Peer_Review/ ← both peer reviews + responses
 ■■■ correspondence/ ← advisor updates & meeting

Boundaries held

No AI/LLM items in this survey (future extension) · No employer / client / engagement-level / sensitive data
 · Wording-and-flow-only revisions during pilot; scope changes escalate to advisor + IRB.